



VAMSI KRISHNA POTHURU

ABOUT

I am currently a PhD scholar specialising in communication and media studies at Department of Communication, University of Hyderabad. My research area focuses on misinformation and digital media literacy in rural India.

WORK EXPERIENCE

FACT CHECKER

NewsMeter | Freelance | July 2020- Jan 2021, Hyderabad

- As a fact-checker, I was responsible for verifying misinformation and writing fact-check articles. NewsMeter is an IFCN (International Fact Checking Network) certified media house in Hyderabad.

ASSOCIATE EDITOR

GD Research Center | Fulltime | Jan 2021- Mar 2021, Hyderabad

- As an Associate Editor, I have authored and edited SEO-optimized business intelligence reports and news features for global B2B audiences,

TEACHING FELLOW

Ashoka University | Contractual | Aug 2023- Jan 2024, Haryana

- Worked as a teaching associate for the foundation course 'Media and Democracy' for the undergraduate students in the Department of Media Studies at Ashoka University.

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Dept. of Communication | University of Hyderabad

- Fulfilled the role of teaching assistant for the courses 'Media Law & Ethics' and 'Communication Research Methods' for Master's students.

ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

MA THESIS

- Submitted a co-authored Master's thesis titled "Information Disorder in India: A Study of the Response from Fact-Checking Websites through a Content Analysis" in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the Master's degree.

REPORTER AND FEATURE WRITER

Internship | The New Indian Express | June-July 2019, Hyderabad

- Worked as a Reporter and Feature Writer, contributing news reports and long-form feature articles; authored a coverstory on the water crisis in Hyderabad.

CONTENT WRITER

Internship | Kriti Social Initiatives | May-June 2019, Hyderabad

- Prepared the organization's annual report, with responsibilities including content development, stakeholder interviews, and the case studies.

CONTACT

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SOCIAL

<https://in.linkedin.com/in/vamsi-krishna-pothuru-73a025119>

<https://newsmeter.in/author/vamsikrishna/>

<https://www.newindianexpress.com/author/vamsi-krishna-pothuru>

EDUCATION

PHD, COMMUNICATION

Dept. of Communication
University of Hyderabad
2021 - Present

MA, MASS COMMUNICATION

University of Hyderabad
2018-2020 | GPA 8.76

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY

AP IIIT, RGUKT 2013 -
2017 | GPA 8.023

FELLOWSHIPS/GRANTS

- UGC-NET Qualified (2020)
- NET-JRF Qualified (2021-26)
- Recipient of IOE Travel grant (2023)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

POSTER PRESENTATION AT 'SPARC NATIONAL CONCLAVE', KOLKATA 2026

- Presented a poster titled 'Local Knowledge and Community Radio: Learnings from the Field' at the national conclave under the SPARC (Scheme for Promotion of Academic and Research Collaboration) project, Government of India, held at the IIT Kharagpur research park, Kolkata on 8 & 9 March, 2026.

PAPER PRESENTATION AT 'IAMCR' ANNUAL CONFERENCE, LYON 2023

- Presented a research paper titled 'Fake News Violence and WhatsApp: Grassroot Awareness Efforts to Empower Rural Citizens in India' at the annual conference of the 'International Association for Media and Communication Research' (IAMCR) on 9-13 July, 2023

PAPER PRESENTATION AT 'ICA' ANNUAL CONFERENCE, REGIONAL HUB, MAHE, 2023

- Presented my research paper titled 'Fact-checking movement in India: Empowering Ordinary Citizens through Digital Media Literacy' at the annual conference of the 'International Communication Association' (ICA), Regional hub at Manipal Institute of Communication, MAHE, Manipal on 26-30 May, 2023

PAPER PRESENTATION AT 'IAMCR' ANNUAL CONFERENCE, 2022

- Presented my research paper online titled 'Information Disorder in India: Tracing the Emergence of Fact-checking Initiatives' at the annual conference of the IAMCR on 11-15 July 2022.

PAPER PRESENTATION AT 'MEDIATRON' MEDIA SYMPOSIUM, JYOTI NIVAS COLLEGE, 2021

- Co-presented a research paper online titled 'Information disorder in India: A Study of Response from Fact-Checking Websites through a Content Analysis' organised by the Center for Media Studies at Jyoti Nivas College Autonomous held on 18-19 February, 2021.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS & CERTIFICATIONS

RESEARCH ASSISTANT, UNESCO CHAIR ON COMMUNITY MEDIA

- Currently working as a research assistant with the UNESCO Chair on Community Media at the Department of Communication, University of Hyderabad.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT, SPARC PROJECT, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA (GOI)

- Currently working as a research assistant for the SPARC (Scheme for Promotion of Academic and Research Collaboration), Government of India (GOI) project titled "Community Media, Participation and the Decolonisation of Knowledge Systems."

RESEARCH ASSISTANT, IPDC, UNESCO

- I worked as a research assistant for the IPDC (International Programme for the Development of Communication), UNESCO project titled "Indigenous Languages and Community Radio in India: Strengthening Capacities of Community Radios to Promote and Revitalize Indigenous Languages."

FACULTY DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME (FDP), St. Philomena's College, Mysore

- Participated in a six-day national-level FDP on 'Social Science Research Methods: Exploring Theories, Practices, Applications in Contemporary Studies' instructed by Prof. Srinivas Melkote at St. Philomena's College (Autonomous), Mysore, from February 13-19, 2025

FACULTY DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME (FDP), Service Setu Academics

- Participated in FDP on 'Gen AI for Teaching and Research' organised by Service Setu Academics online, 8-9 December, 2025

PUBLICATIONS

- Pothuru, V. K. (2025, August 13). Deepfakes, cloned voices, and digital media literacy: AI's role in the misinformation crisis in India. WACC Global. <https://waccglobal.org/deepfakes-cloned-voices-and-digital-media-literacy-ais-role-in-the-misinformation-crisis-in-india/>
- Pothuru, V. K. (2023). Fighting fake news on the ground: Empowering Indian villages through a grassroots approach. In O. Manzar & D. Arora (Eds.), Truth and deception in the digital age: Navigating the culture of misinformation (pp. 175–). Centre for Development Policy and Practice.
- Malik, K. K., & Pothuru, V. K. (2023, August 16). Harnessing media literacy to navigate social media echo chambers in India. WACC Global. <https://waccglobal.org/harnessing-media-literacy-to-navigate-social-media-echo-chambers-in-india/>
- Pavarala, V., Malik, K. K., Belavadi, V., Jena, A., John, T. R., & Pothuru, V. K. (in press). Indigenous languages and community radio in India: A handbook. UNESCO. (Forthcoming)
- Pothuru, V. K. (in press). Factchecking locations. In M. Ravikumar (Ed.), Advance digital journalism. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Open University. (Forthcoming)
- Pothuru, V. K. (2023, November 18). Exit Alfaz-e-Mewat; enter “Connect FM 107.8”. CR News, 14(2). UNESCO Chair on Community Media, University of Hyderabad. <https://ucommedia.uohyd.ac.in/news/exit-alfaz-e-mewat-enter-connect-fm-107-8/>
- Pothuru, V. K., et al. (2024). Building a safety benchmark dataset in Hindi. [Project contribution]. Tattle. <https://tattle.co.in/products/ml-commons-safety-benchmark/>
- Pothuru, V. K. (n.d.). Author profile. NewsMeter. <https://newsmeter.in/author/vamsikrishna>
- Pothuru, V. K. (n.d.). Author profile. The New Indian Express. <https://www.newindianexpress.com/author/vamsi-krishna-pothuru>

DECLARATION

I, Vamsi Krishna Pothuru, hereby declare that the information contained herein is true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

P. Vamsi Krishna

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